

PUJA MAHTANI

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Work Experience

hc1.com, Remote – Senior Product Designer, Founding

Jun 2023 - May 2026

AI-NATIVE PRODUCT DESIGN

- Designed an AI decision-support tool as the sole designer, building trust patterns that showed users why the system recommended an action and kept them in control, cutting response time to under 2 minutes.
- Owned end-to-end UX for an AI-powered analytics platform with two agentic workflows, turning dense, high-volume data into interfaces teams could act on across a \$25–30M portfolio, uncovering up to \$850K in savings and cutting manual analysis by over 70%.
- Led a 0-to-1 predictive platform from customer discovery through coded prototypes to launch, defining requirements with no existing spec, achieving 18% cost reduction and 34% efficiency gain within 6 months.

END TO END PRODUCT DESIGN

- Rebuilt a high-density enterprise configuration platform through 8 stakeholder interviews and 6 usability tests, restructuring information architecture to cut task time by 60% and triple active users.
- Consolidated 2 legacy tools into Data Control Center, a guided self-serve data platform, through a build-vs-buy evaluation, reducing customer activation time by 48% and enabling 2x faster data onboarding.

DESIGN SYSTEMS AND STANDARDS

- Built the company's first design system on Shadcn serving 4 product lines, with design tokens, Figma libraries, and Storybook documentation, improving team velocity by 25% and shortening release cycles by 20%.

hc1.com, Indianapolis, IN – Product Design Intern

May 2022 - Dec 2022

- Established the UX foundation as the first designer, defining design processes, component libraries, and documentation standards that reduced design-to-development friction by 60%.
- Led discovery and initial design for an AI-powered lab staffing solution through contextual inquiry with clinical operators, mapping scheduling constraints into user flows that informed the production roadmap.

Indiana University, Indianapolis – UX Research Assistant

Sep 2021 - May 2023

- Directed NSF-funded mixed-method research under Dr. Erin Brady, designing and executing studies with 20+ participants to validate design decisions and inform product direction.

GraffersID, Remote – UX Designer

Jun 2020 - Jun 2021

- Delivered end-to-end UX/UI across 15+ enterprise and startup client engagements in agile environments, making fast trade-off decisions that cut project timelines by 25%.
- Overhauled the company website conversion architecture through user flow analysis and competitive research, increasing engagement by 35% and client conversions by 18%.

Education

Master of Science in Human-Computer Interaction, Indiana University, Indianapolis

Aug 2021 - May 2023

Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Engineering, University of Mumbai

Jul 2016 - Aug 2020

Skills

- Design:** Interaction Design, Visual Design, Information Architecture, Data Visualization, Responsive Design, Design Systems (Shadcn), Design Tokens, Accessibility (WCAG)
- Strategy & Research:** Product Strategy, Customer Discovery, Usability Testing, 0-to-1 Product Design, Experimentation, Stakeholder Management, Agile
- Code:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, TypeScript, TailwindCSS, SQL, GitHub, VS Code
- AI:** AI/ML Interaction Patterns, LLM-Powered Interfaces, Agentic UX, Trust & Human-in-the-Loop, AI-Assisted Prototyping
- Tools:** Figma, FigJam, Claude, Claude Code, Cursor, Figma Make, Bolt, Storybook, Miro, Jira, Looker

Leadership

- Pioneered an AI-assisted prototyping pipeline using coding agents (Claude Code, Cursor, Bolt) that shipped production-ready React components from design intent, cutting design-to-development handoff time by 50%.
- Facilitated a hands-on product design workshop at Stevens Institute of Technology, guiding students through end-to-end product development across research, design systems, and product analytics.